

OPSC6311

POE Part 2

Documentation

Kylah Irvine - ST10435066
Sivikelwe Nxumalo - ST10448374

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Introduction

As discussed in Part 1 of the assignment, Centric is a personal budgeting application custom-built for the South African student experience and the country at large. It aims to simplify money management by unifying expense tracking, category management and budget goal setting into an intuitive platform.

Functionality:

The prototype focuses on robust authentication and essential financial tracking:

Authentication: Users can register an account and log in. The application utilizes a secure local database to manage user credentials. If a user is not registered, the system prompts them to create an account, which is then verified against the secure database.

Home Dashboard: Upon successful login, users are directed to the home dashboard, which displays the current remaining balance.

Expense and Category Management: The interface allows for the seamless addition of spending categories and specific expenses (including description, amount and due date).

Budgeting: The app supports the definition of minimum and maximum budget goals helping users maintain financial discipline.

Data Aggregation: The application processes data to provide summarized views, such as category-specific totals, enabling clear oversight of personal spending.

Prototype Evaluation:

Strengths:

- The interface is snappy and responsive, providing quick feedback for actions like login and data entry. This ensures a smooth user experience.
- The secure handling of user accounts offers a reliable authentication and ensures that personal data is protected.
- The application directly addresses a real-world problem with features that are essential and relevant.

- Successful connectivity to a secure local database establishes a solid foundation for persistent and reliable data management.

Weaknesses:

- As a prototype, several proposed features are currently placeholders or are not yet fully functional. For example, the expense list view within the app needs to be populated with dynamic data and the innovative feature has not yet been implemented.
- While effective locally, further testing and optimization will be required to handle larger datasets as the app matures.
- The current user interface acts as a functional skeleton. Further visual refinement and accessibility improvements will be necessary to enhance usability.
- The innovative "split expense" functionality, aimed at facilitating collaborative budgeting among users, is a key differentiator that currently requires further development to become fully functional and reliable.